Perla – Dental Clinic theme for Divi 5

Thank you for your purchase! Setting up takes about five minutes: you install the theme and it builds the demo site for you.

Before you start

You need:

- A self-hosted WordPress site (not a WordPress.com free plan).
- The **Divi theme, version 5.4 or newer**, installed. Divi is sold separately by Elegant Themes and is not included in this download.

A new WordPress site is best. If your site already has content, back it up first.

What is in the download

File	What it is
`perla-child.zip`	The theme. Upload this file to WordPress exactly as it is: do not unzip it.
`Perla-Setup-Guide`	This guide.
`Perla-Pages-for-Divi-Library.json`	Optional. The page layouts as a Divi Library file (see step 4).
`Perla-Theme-Builder-Templates.json`	Optional. Header, footer and templates as a Theme Builder file (see step 4).

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1. Install the theme

1. Go to **Appearance → Themes → Add New Theme → Upload Theme**.
2. Choose `perla-child.zip`, click **Install Now**, then **Activate**.

That is all. On a new WordPress site the theme builds the demo site by itself, in a few seconds, and then shows the **Perla Setup** screen with the list of what it created:

- 11 pages: Home, About, Services, one page for each of the six treatments, Blog and Contact
- the header and footer, the blog post template and the 404 page
- the main menu
- the colours, fonts and design variables of the theme
- three sample articles for the blog
- 18 demo photos, added to your Media Library

Open your site: it now looks like the demo, photos and scroll animations included.

If your site already has content

The theme never changes a site that already has pages or posts of its own. After you activate it you see the **Perla Setup** screen with one button: **Install the demo site**.

Only what is missing is added. A page that already exists at the same address (for example `/about/`), your menu, your Theme Builder templates and your posts are left exactly as they are, and the screen lists what was added and what was left alone.

You find the screen again at any time under **Appearance → Perla Setup**. **Run the set-up again** re-creates anything you have deleted, without touching the rest.

If something goes wrong

- **"The theme is missing the style.css stylesheet"**: WordPress received the wrong file. Upload `perla-child.zip` itself, not a folder and not a zip that contains it. Safari on a Mac unzips downloads automatically: in that case compress the `perla-child` folder again, or download the file with another browser.
- **"The parent theme is missing"**: install Divi first, then install Perla.
- **"Perla needs the Divi theme, version 5.4 or newer"**: update Divi, then open **Appearance → Perla Setup** and click the button.
- **"Divi ... has changed something the automatic set-up of Perla relies on"**: you have a version of Divi that is newer than this version of Perla knows. Nothing on your site was changed. Ask for the latest version of Perla, or add the pages by hand as described in step 4.

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2. Make it yours

Clinic details, in one place

Open any page with the Divi builder and open the **Variable Manager** in the left bar. Change these once and they update in the header, the footer and every page:

- Clinic Name, Phone Number, Email Address, Address, Opening Hours
- Phone Link (`tel:+1...`) and Email Link (`mailto:...`)
- Booking Page (where the "Book a visit" buttons go)

The cards under the first section of the Home page and the list on the Contact page show the same variables, so they update too.

Your logo

Go to **Divi → Theme Builder**, open the **Global Header**, click the Menu module and replace the logo image. A transparent PNG about 120 px high works well (it is shown 40 px high).

Colours and fonts

In the same Variable Manager you find every colour of the theme (Primary, Secondary, Heading, Body, Dark Background, Soft Blue Background and more) and the corner radius, spacing and text size settings. The two fonts are under **Divi → Theme Customizer → General Settings → Typography**.

Three ready-made palettes you can type in:

Palette	Primary	Primary – Hover	Secondary	Dark Background	Soft Blue Background
Ocean (default)	`#1a66e8`	`#114db8`	`#12b5a5`	`#081632`	`#edf4ff`
Mint	`#0b7f70`	`#086257`	`#1a66e8`	`#06302b`	`#e8f7f4`
Lavender	`#6d4de0`	`#5136b5`	`#12b5a5`	`#1a1240`	`#f1edff`

Photos

The demo photos are in your **Media Library**. They are stock pictures of models, there to show how the pages look: replace them with photos of your own clinic and team. Click a photo in the builder and choose another one. Sizes that fit the layouts:

Where	Size
Hero, About, Story	960 × 1040 px (portrait)
Treatment pages	960 × 860 px
Team members	640 × 760 px
Before / after	960 × 720 px, both the same size
Blog posts (featured image)	1200 × 750 px

Good to know about the demo photos:

- **Before / after.** The two pictures are one photo, retouched to show how the slider works. They are not a real case. Use photos of your own patients, with their consent, or delete the section.
- **Where they come from.** All of them come from Pexels and are used under the Pexels licence. The file `demo/images/CREDITS.txt` inside the theme lists each photo with its photographer and source. Each photo also carries its credit in the Media Library.
- Once you have replaced a demo photo you can delete it from the Media Library.

Team and reviews

The team, the reviews, the star rating and the numbers are examples written for an invented clinic. Put in your own before the site goes live: your real team, reviews your patients have actually

written, your own figures. The round badge on each review shows the initials of the person: change the two letters, no photo needed.

Treatment pages

Each treatment has its own page under **Pages → Services**: General Dentistry, Cosmetic Dentistry, Dental Implants, Teeth Whitening, Orthodontics and Emergency Care. Each page has its own photo and texts: change them, the "At a glance" facts and the prices to match what you offer. Dental Implants also shows a price table: delete that section if you do not publish prices.

Do you not offer a treatment? Move its page to the trash, then remove its card on the Home and Services pages and its link in the footer.

Contact form

Open the Contact page, click the form and add the email address that should receive requests. The form uses Divi's built-in captcha; you can connect a spam protection service in the same panel.

Map

On the Contact page, click the map (a Code module) and replace `Springfield,+IL` in the address with your own, using `+` instead of spaces, for example `10+Main+Street,+Boston`.

Menu

The theme creates a menu with Home, About, Services, Blog and Contact. Change it in **Appearance → Menus**.

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3. Animations

Perla animates the pages while your visitors scroll:

- titles are revealed line by line;
- cards, list items and buttons appear one after another;
- large photos are unveiled from the bottom;
- on computers, the top section of each page shrinks into a rounded card as the page scrolls on;
- with a mouse wheel or a trackpad the page glides instead of jumping (smooth scrolling). Phones and tablets keep their own scrolling, which is already smooth.

None of this runs inside the Divi builder, so you always edit the finished page. Visitors who have asked their device to reduce motion see the pages without animations and with normal scrolling.

Turn them off

Go to **Appearance → Perla Setup**. Under **Animations** there are two boxes:

- **Play the scroll animations** switches everything off when you untick it.

- **Smooth scrolling with the mouse wheel and the trackpad** switches off only the gliding and keeps the animations.

Click **Save**.

If a pop-up or a chat window from another plugin does not scroll properly with the mouse wheel, switch the smooth scrolling off: some plugins do not expect it.

Animate something you add

Every animation is a class name. Open the settings of a module, row or section in the builder, go to the **Advanced** tab and open **Attributes**. Click **Add Attribute**, type `class` as the attribute name and one of these names as its value:

Class	Use it on	What it does
`perla-reveal`	any module	Fades in while it rises.
`perla-stagger`	a row, a column or a group	Its items appear one after another.
`perla-split`	a Heading module	The title is revealed line by line.
`perla-image`	an Image module	The picture is unveiled from the bottom.
`perla-pop`	a row with a background	The panel grows to its full size as it scrolls into view.
`perla-hero`	the first section of a page	The section shrinks into a card while the page scrolls on.

To remove an animation from a module, delete that attribute.

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4. Optional: the layouts as Divi files

You do not need these files for a normal set-up. They are useful in two cases.

To build more pages from the Perla layouts, add them to your Divi Library. (Layouts added this way show the demo photos straight from the theme folder.)

1. Go to **Divi → Divi Library** and click **Import & Export**.
2. Open the **Import** tab, choose `Perla-Pages-for-Divi-Library.json` and click **Import Divi Builder Layouts**.
3. Create a page, click **Use Divi Builder**, then the **+** button at the top of the left bar → **Saved Layout** → **Your Saved Layouts**. Pick a "Perla –" layout and click **Use This Layout**.

To add the Perla header and footer to a site that already had Theme Builder templates (the set-up leaves those alone):

1. Go to **Divi → Theme Builder** and click the **Portability** icon (two arrows) at the top right.

2. Open the **Import** tab and choose `Perla-Theme-Builder-Templates.json`. Leave **Override Existing Default Website Template** ticked to show the Perla header and footer on the whole site, then click **Import Divi Theme Builder Templates**.
3. Click **Save Changes**.

Templates you already had for blog posts or for the 404 page are kept as "Unassigned": delete them, or assign them again if you prefer yours.

Good to know

- **Sample content of WordPress.** "Hello world!" and "Sample Page" come with every new WordPress site. You can delete them.
- **Privacy policy and Terms.** The footer links to `/privacy-policy/` and `/terms/`. WordPress prepares a draft privacy policy for you under **Pages**: complete and publish it, and create a Terms page, or remove the two links in the Global Footer.
- **The header stays at the top while scrolling.** To turn this off, open the header section in the Theme Builder, type "sticky" in the settings search box and set the sticky position to *Do Not Stick*.
- **Blog cards** show your real posts. Add a featured image to each post for the best result.
- **Sample articles.** The three articles are examples of how a post looks. Rewrite them or delete them: they are general dental advice, not written for your patients.
- **Blog posts** do not repeat the featured image at the top. To show it, open the "All Posts" template in the Theme Builder and enable the image in the Post Title module.
- **Updating Divi** does not touch your pages. They are standard Divi content kept in your WordPress database, and Perla is a separate child theme: an update only replaces Divi's own files. Newer versions of Divi convert older layouts by themselves when they show or open a page. This version of Perla was tested with Divi 5.4.0 and 5.15.1. As with any update, make a backup first.
- **Updating Perla.** Upload the new `perla-child.zip` the same way and choose *Replace installed with uploaded*. Your pages stay exactly as you edited them. If you would rather have the new version of the demo pages, use **Appearance → Perla Setup → Restore the demo pages**: it replaces the changes you made to the pages Perla created, so use it before you start editing or on pages you are happy to redo. Coming from a version older than 1.4? Restoring is also what brings in the demo photos. The sample articles are left as they are: to get the new ones, move the three old ones to the Trash and click **Run the set-up again**.
- **Restored a page by mistake?** WordPress keeps the earlier versions of every page, unless revisions are switched off on your site. Go to **Pages**, click **Edit** under the page and click **Revisions** in the panel on the right.

Before you go live

- [ ] Clinic details changed in the Variable Manager

- [ ] Your logo, your colours
- [ ] Demo photos replaced with your own, the before / after pair included
- [ ] Team, reviews, rating, numbers and prices replaced with real ones
- [ ] Email address set in the contact form, and a test message received
- [ ] Your address on the map
- [ ] Privacy policy and Terms pages published, sample articles rewritten or deleted

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Need help?

Send a message through the shop where you bought the theme. Please include a screenshot of what you see and the line at the bottom of **Appearance → Perla Setup**, which shows your versions of Perla, Divi and WordPress.

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